Behaviour Support Plan (BSP)process

At Little Miracles we value each child's individual personality, strengths, and interests. Little Miracles endeavours to provide a safe, educational, and supportive environment for all children, families, and educators.

At times children go through different journeys and can display behaviours that are challenging. When a child displays challenging behaviours, it has an impact on the environment around them which can include peers, families, educators, and the physical environment. Reasonable adjustments are made to optimise access, participation and engagement in learning whilst ensuring the rights and dignity of each child and the safety and wellbeing of children and staff is maintained.

Little Miracles endeavour to support families through these times by providing a 'Behaviour Support Plan' for those children. A behaviour plan is for children who might finding it a challenge to manage their behaviour due to a diagnosed additional need, mental health, emotional challenges or other reasons.

Behaviour plans, also known as **Behaviour Support Plans (BSPs)**, are a process designed to address and manage challenging behaviours in individuals. These plans provide inclusive strategies and concise goals tailored to an individual's needs. The plan promotes positive behavioural outcomes whilst still providing high quality care for the whole group of children.

Collaborative Partnerships with Families and Community

The success of a behaviour support plan (BSP) depends on collaboration between the child, their family, educators, and other professionals involved in their care. The plan should be implemented consistently across all settings, including home, school, and community environments, to ensure that the strategies are effective, and the child experiences consistent support.

Little Miracles values, respects and fosters collaborative partnerships with families, allied health and other professionals to support children's learning, development and wellbeing. When a child is displaying 'Challenging Behaviours' educators are to communicate and share information with families respectfully and with empathy and sensitivity.

Key points to keep in mind when implementing this process:

- Every child and family are unique and therefore each situation will be approached in its own context.
- The continuation of the 'Behaviour Plan' will depend on the ongoing healthy partnership between the family, educators in the room and centre leadership team. This includes all stakeholder's adherence to the 'Social Covenant' that parents and staff sign committing to working together in a constructive partnership.
- Little Miracles understands each family needs to consider what's best for them. If during this process you choose to cease care, we will respect your decision and waive the '4 week notice period'.

Examples of children who may benefit from an individual **'Behaviour Support Plan' (BSP**)

Individuals Displaying Challenging Behaviours

Patterns of behaviour that persist over time and do not appear to be eased by general guiding behaviour strategies. This includes aggressive or disruptive behaviours that impact the health, safety and wellbeing of peers and educators. (An 'Incident/ Injury or Trauma Report' will additionally be completed documenting any incident).

To be considered as challenging behaviour, behaviour should be persistent and not responsive to general behaviour guidance techniques used in our centres.

- Behaviours which are frequent and intense in nature.
- Physical and verbal aggression towards others including peers and educators.

Individuals needing additional Well-Being Support: Children can benefit from BSPs to enhance their overall emotional and psychological well-being.

- Anxiety
- Separation anxiety
- Withdrawn, self-isolating behaviour
- Self-injurious behaviours

A child requiring a 'Behaviour Support Plan' (PBS) can be identified in the following ways:

- Initial enrolment process.
- Educator observation-'EYLF Developmental Milestones' can be used as an observation tool.
- Ongoing challenging behaviours that impact the safety and well-being of the child, their peers or educators. Eg aggressive behaviours resulting in incidents.
- Parent/Guardian communication.
- Medical professional diagnosis that communicates a child need and benefit of a 'BSP'

"Children's learning is ongoing, and each child will progress towards the outcomes in different and equally meaningful ways. Learning is not always predictable and linear. Educators plan with each child and the outcomes in mind." - (Early Years Learning Framework, p.19)

Environment Audit

The physical design of an environment has a large impact on how children behave in that space. When the environment is designed well it is often defined as the "third teacher" (Reggio Emilia). The Growing Champions guidebook is a tool for educators to utilise and guide best practise. The vision is for educators to follow each petal in a clockwise pattern to achieve an effective learning environment that promotes positive behavioural outcomes.

When a child's behaviour is identified as 'challenging', the Nominated Supervisor will guide the Room Leader and educators to reflect on the room environment using these key elements: (*A great way to assess the environment is to use the growing Champions environment audit)*

- **Physical environment**



-How is the environment set up? (Consider sensitising factors).

- Is routine being followed?

-Are transitions being completed consistently?

-Active supervision occurring?

- **Room Expectations-**

- Are the room expectations age appropriate?

- Are they being implemented consistently as a team?

- **Misguided Behaviour**-



- Are the behaviours being displayed age appropriate?
- Are existing strategies being implemented consistently as a team?
- Is the 'Growing Champions' guidebook being used as a resource to support the child/children and or environment?
- Is positive guidance and encouragement toward acceptable behaviour being implemented? Eg rights and dignity of children
- Are educator's responses considerate of children's developmental age.

Family Collaboration Form

A **'Family Collaboration Form'** is to be completed to document any relevant conversations with families. This document provides clear communication between families and educators with relevant and important information about a child's challenging behaviour.

Conversations to document may include:

- Initial conversations communicating any challenging behaviours or well-being concerns including the impacts to peers, educators and environment.
- Families sharing strategies and ideas.
- Families providing updated information regarding their child's behaviour and wellbeing.
- Families providing helpful information on child's interests and strengths.
- Educators communicating any step of the 'Behaviour Support (BSP) process' to families.

Educators will not begin the Behaviour Support Process (BSP) within the first 4 weeks of the year or when a child changes rooms to allow any children to transition and settle into new learning environments.

Strategies

Developing proactive strategies are key in addressing the underlying causes of challenging behaviours and prevent them from occurring. These strategies might include modifying the environment, providing sensory supports, using visual schedules, or teaching the individual new skills. It's important to consider the child's voice, interests and needs when developing these strategies, as well as the resources available in each setting.

- Following reflection of the environment, the Room leader will create in collaboration with the family and team of educator's individual reasonable strategies for the child. These strategies are to be recorded on a 'Family Collaboration form' kept in tab 2 in the rooms 'Emergency Folder'.
- The strategies will be implemented by the room for a minimum of 2-week period. Families will be provided with ongoing progress of the strategies and any relevant family conversations documented on a 'Family Collaboration Form'.
- At the end of the 2 weeks, the strategies will be reviewed at a room leader meeting and the Area Manager along with the Nominated Supervisor will decide if the Child will move onto a 'Behaviour support Plan' (BSP).

Behaviour Support Plan (BSP) steps:

Step 1-Family Meeting-

Before creating the **'Behaviour Support Plan' (BSP)** the Nominated Supervisor is to organise a 'Family Meeting' with the parents/guardian along with the Room leader. This meeting is the opportunity to communicate and collaborate with families.

- Once a meeting date with the family is set the Area Manager will coordinate in collaboration with the Nominated Supervisor the planning, preparing and implementation of the meeting.
- This will be completed in person or video online. If family cannot attend the meeting, information about the process and the 'Behaviour Support Plan' will be sent to the family via email.
- The Area Manager will support the Nominated Supervisor or educators with -any coaching or guidance in the facilitation of the meeting.
- The Family Collaboration form is to be used to document relevant conversations from the meeting.

Discussion points during the 'Family Meeting':

- Communicate the vision of working collaboratively together with the family and the goal to achieve positive behaviour outcomes for the child.
- The child's current individual needs or behaviour concerns within the learning environment and the impacts to the learning environment and group of children, including the child.
- Offer opportunity for the family to provide information regarding their child "Are there similar behaviours displayed at home"?
- Communicate and discuss the current steps and strategies the room is implementing. Eg 'Environment audit',
- Nominated Supervisor or Area Manager will communicate to the family the commencement of the 'Behaviour Support Plan' (BSP).
- Communicate the vision of the 'Behaviour Support Plan' process including what the next steps will be e.g. 'Challenging Behaviour Form' (Sand coloured form), Monthly reviews with the family and the potential cessation of care if a child's behaviour or care continues to be unsustainable.
- Provide opportunity for the family to collaborate and contribute input in the creation of the strategies for the child's 'Behaviour Support Plan'.
- Provide the family with any relevant resources eg 'Relationships with Children Policy, blank BSP form, information sheets, Allied Health referral information etc.

Step 2 - Communication with family and creating BSP (Behaviour Support Plan)

- Nominated Supervisor, Area Manager and Room Leader will create an 'Behaviour Support Plan' (ISP) considering family and child input if provided.
- The Nominated Supervisor and Room Leader will provide opportunity for a 10 Minute conversation with the child's family the following week to inform the commencement date of 'Behaviour Support Plan (BSP) and the strategies educators will be implementing.
- Attach a copy of the family's signed Social Covenant to the completed BSP.
- Following the 10-minute conversation a follow up email will be sent to the family which will include:
    - A copy of the child's 'Behaviour Support Plan' (BSP).
    - 'Behaviour Support Plan Process' package which includes blank documents that will be utilised during the process.
    - The Nominated Supervisor will **BCC** the Area Manager into the email that is sent to the family.

Step 3- Communicate and Document- *The Room Leader is to document when a child is displaying significant challenging behaviours while on a 'Behaviour Support Plan (BSP). Educators are to document and communicate using the following steps.*

- Complete 'Challenging Behaviour Form' and incident/ injury/ Trauma form when required. Room Leader or Responsible Person will talk to the family.
- Room Leader or Room assistant to record on the 'Challenging Behaviours' Log form.
- Room Leader to communicate to the Nominated Supervisor and Area Manager at weekly room leader meetings if a child has received a 'Challenging Behaviour Form'.
- The Nominated Supervisor is to organise the completion of 'Growing Champions Environment Audit'. (if not already completed) The audit will be reviewed and discussed with the Nominated Supervisor and Area Manager at the next room leader meeting

If a child receives TWO 'Challenging Behaviour Forms' or 'Incident, Injury or Trauma' forms on any day, the Nominated Supervisor or Responsible Person will review the impact of the behaviour, and a decision will be made if the parent/ guardian will be contacted and asked to collect the child from care early.

Step 4: Implementing and reviewing 'Behaviour Support Plan' (BSP)

Weeks 1-4

- The 'Behaviour Support Plan' (BSP) will begin on the FIRST Monday after the families have been emailed the child's 'Behaviour Support Plan' (BSP).
- Room educators are to record progress notes on the child's 'Behaviour Support Plan' (BSP). These notes will be communicated at Room Leader meetings and will assist in the reviewing of the effectiveness of strategies.
- Room educators are to consistently implement the BSP strategies and document progress notes while continuing step 3.
- This process will run for 4 weeks with a review in week 5.
- During the 4 weeks the Nominated Supervisor is to spend a minimum of 1 hr in the room on the floor to inspect and ensure all educators are implementing the 'Behaviour Support Plan' (BSP) strategies.
- If a child, no longer displays significant challenging behaviours, the Area Manager in collaboration with the Nominated supervisor can cease the BSP process at any time.

Step 5. Review of strategies

Week 5

- Nominated Supervisor, Area Manager and Room Leader will review the Behaviour Support Plan (BSP) strategies and their progress.
- Following the review of strategies the Area Manager will make one of the following decisions:
    - End the 'Behaviour Support Plan Process' (the child no longer requires 'Behaviour Support')- Letter is provided to the family to notify the cessation of the BSP.
    - Continue the 'Behaviour Support Plan' and create a 2nd BSP for 4 more weeks with family and child input. **Continue to step 6.**

If a child is placing children or educators at risk of 'significant harm', the child's enrolment may be ceased and the child released from care immediately. To minimise the impact on families Little Miracles will waive the '4- week notice period'.

Step 6: 2nd 'Family Meeting' The Area Manager in collaboration with the Nominated supervisor will organise and conduct a 2nd 'Family Meeting'.

Week 6

- Once a meeting date with the family is set the Area Manager will coordinate in collaboration with the Nominated Supervisor the planning and implementation of the meeting.
- This will be completed in person or via online video. If family cannot attend the meeting, the information will be sent to the family via email.
- The Area Manager will support the Nominated Supervisor or educators with any coaching or guidance in the facilitation of the meeting.

Discussion points during the 'Family Meeting':

- Updates and Progress of the BSP
- Communicate any current challenges and impacts to the child, peers, educators and environment.
- Reasonable strategies that Little Miracles can implement to provide 'Extra Support' will be discussed during the meeting. This will include options for continued care at Little Miracles e.g., reduced hours, reduction of days of of care.
- External options for further support that families can access such as NDIS, referral to specialists and Inclusion Support Funding (ISS). (Information for specialist form can be provided to the family if helpful).
- Provide opportunity for the family to collaborate and contribute input in the review of the strategies.
- Clear expectations that if at the 10-week review period the child's 'Challenging behaviours' is still at an unsustainable level, or the family has not shown commitment in working together in a constructive and collaborative partnership then the child will be released from care.

Step 7: Continuation of Behaviour Support Plan

Week 7 - 9

- Nominated Supervisor, Area Manager and Room Leader will update or create new strategies, if necessary, on the 'Behaviour Support Plan' (BSP) considering family and child input if provided.
- The Nominated Supervisor and Room Leader will provide opportunity for a 10 Minute conversation with the child's family the following week to inform them of any updates or changes to strategies on their child's BSP that educators will be implementing.
- Following the 10-minute conversation a follow up email will be sent to the family which will include:
    - A copy of the child's updated 'Behaviour Support Plan' (BSP).
    - The Nominated Supervisor will **BCC** the Area Manager into the email that is sent to the family.
- Room educators are to consistently implement the BSP strategies and document progress notes while continuing step 3.
- Room educators are to record progress notes on the child's 'Behaviour Support Plan' (BSP). These notes will be communicated at Room Leader meetings and will assist in the reviewing of the effectiveness of strategies.
- This process will run for 4 weeks with a review in week 9
- During the 4 weeks the Nominated Supervisor is to spend a minimum of 1 hr in the room on the floor to inspect and ensure all educators are implementing the 'Behaviour Support Plan' (BSP) strategies.
- If a child, no longer displays significant challenging behaviours, the Area Manager in collaboration with the Nominated supervisor can cease the BSP process at any time.
- In week 9 the Nominated Supervisor, Area Manager and Room Leader will review the 2nd BSP strategies and its effectiveness.

Step 8: Final Step-*Following consultation with the Nominated supervisor and room leader/educators the Area Manager will decide from the following options of the next action step:*

Week 10

Option 1: Continued Care End of BSP
If care is sustainable and the child is no longer requiring 'Extra Support' the child's 'Behaviour Support Plan' will end.

Option 2: Release of care
If no significant change has been achieved, Nominated Supervisor is to notify the Area Manager that the child's level of individual care continues to be unreasonable or a risk to others safety. The Area Manager will take steps to finalise/end child's care.